

API Usage Tracking Guide

Why the API-key usage pages can look empty, and every way to make them work — including the locally-measured ledger that is already wired in and needs no special key at all.

Written 15 July 2026 · applies to Claude Account Manager 1.1+ · this PC's Lifted desktop apps

1 Why the pages show nothing

The app asks each provider's billing API for your spend. For most providers that data is simply **not offered to normal API keys** — it is a provider-side restriction, not an app bug. A standard key can prove it is *valid* (the app checks the models endpoint), but the usage endpoints answer 401/403.

PROVIDER	NORMAL KEY	WHAT REAL USAGE DATA NEEDS
Anthropic	X validate-only	An Admin key (<code>sk-ant-admin...</code>) for the organization cost & usage reports
OpenAI	X validate-only	An Admin key (<code>sk-admin-...</code>) for the organization costs & usage endpoints
Gemini (AI Studio)	X impossible	No usage/billing API exists for API keys at all — only GCP Cloud Billing export + OAuth
OpenRouter	✓ works fully	Nothing — a normal <code>sk-or-...</code> key reports spend and balance

2 Fix 1 — locally measured usage

RECOMMENDED · ALREADY WIRED IN

The "Measured locally" panel on the Anthropic provider page

Every Anthropic-calling desktop app on this PC — Stage 2 Processing and its workflow tools (PDF Splitter, PDF Rotator, AI Document Splitter, Re-check Unknowns), ApplAI, Emporium Engine and Lifted Audit Assistant — records the **exact usage block returned by the API on every call** into a shared ledger:

```
%APPDATA%\LiftedPDFTools\api_usage*.jsonl
```

These are real token counts straight from Anthropic — not estimates — and the panel reads them live: past 24 hours / 7 days / 30 days / lifetime spend, broken down per app. Each app also has its own analytics page, and Stage 2's page adds a per-tool breakdown.

Coverage: every call made through those apps on this machine. What it can't see: calls made with the same key from other machines or tools. For a single-PC workflow this is effectively complete.

3 Fix 2 — an Anthropic Admin key

ORGANIZATION ACCOUNTS ONLY

1. Go to **console.anthropic.com** → **Settings** → **Organization** → **API keys**.
2. Create a key with the **Admin** role — it will start `sk-ant-admin...` . (If you never see an Admin option, your account is an individual account and Anthropic does not offer admin keys for it — use Fix 1.)
3. In this app: **API Keys** → **Add key**, paste the admin key — it is auto-detected from the prefix.
4. Refresh — cost & usage now come from Anthropic's own organization reports (org-wide, all keys, all machines).

Treat an admin key like a password: it can read org-wide billing. Prefer a spend-capped, analytics-only workflow and never paste it into other tools.

OpenAI: same idea — create an Admin key (`sk-admin-...`) from platform.openai.com → Settings → Organization → Admin keys, then add it here.

Gemini: no key-based option exists. Track spend via Google Cloud Billing budgets/exports, or route Gemini calls through OpenRouter (whose key reports usage properly).

4 Which numbers should I trust?

Admin-key numbers — authoritative org-wide billing, all machines.

Locally measured numbers — exact for everything done through the desktop apps on this PC, blind to anything else.

If both are present they differ exactly by usage from outside this machine — that difference is itself useful information.

5 Known gap that remains

Even with an admin key, charts backfill only from the moment a key is added — the adapters don't implement history backfill, so day-one charts start sparse and fill as snapshots accumulate.